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Dear Pixar,

I could open this letter the way business school trained me to: a tidy list of my résumé's top bullet points, each expanded to explain why it fits a role here, then the customary paragraph about how much I admire this company and why I connect with its culture. But the four-year-old version of me would slap me clean across the face, ask if that was really how I planned to get into Pixar, then demand I pick him up and fly him around the room while he screamed, "¡Hasta el infinito y más allá!" So instead, I'd like to start by offering you a snow cone.

Yes, a snow cone. Specifically, the yellow ones handed out by the Abominable Snowman in *Monsters, Inc.* When I first watched him as a kid, he seemed like a throwaway gag: a shaggy exile stuck in the Himalayas, trying to make the best of banishment with shaved ice. But the older I got, the more I realized how much depth Pixar tucked into that scene. This "abominable" creature was rumored to be terrifying, yet he turned out to be kind, generous, and misunderstood. "Do I look abominable to you? Why can't they call me the Adorable Snowman?" he protests. Beneath the joke is a character misjudged.

But the story doesn't end there: later lore revealed that he wasn't banished for being abominable at all. He was cast out because he uncovered Watnoose's evil plan. In other words, he was punished for being honest, not dangerous. On the surface, it's a story about not judging too quickly. Beneath it, it's about someone whose truth was ignored and whose value was overlooked. And yet Pixar gave this character's voice to John Ratzenberger.

Most fans know Ratzenberger as Pixar's "lucky charm," a running gag appearing in 22 consecutive feature films. But like the Abominable Snowman, he is far more than the gag. What fewer people stop to ask is why he kept coming back. In interviews, he has said that Pixar was a place where he could walk in with the craziest, funniest ideas and feel that they would actually listen. He even laughed imagining someone pitching *Up*: "Listen, I've got an idea for a movie about an 80-year-old guy who attaches balloons to his house and floats away to Argentina with a Korean Cub Scout. Any other studio would call security." Pixar didn't call security. Pixar leaned in and said, tell us more, just like it did for toys having feelings, a renowned chef being a rat, and automobiles running the world.

That's why Ratzenberger kept returning. Not because he was Pixar's lucky charm, but because Pixar's lucky charm was being a place where the most unlikely ideas and the most unlikely characters were embraced, not dismissed.

That lesson is why the Abominable Snowman has become my favorite Pixar character. To me, he represents what makes Pixar extraordinary: a culture that believes no idea, no person, is too small or too strange to matter.

Pixar's way of working isn't new to me. I went through Story Xperiential, the storytelling program built in partnership with Pixar, won its Excellence in Feedback Award, and stayed on as an alumnus, giving notes to the students who came after me. Watching hundreds of young storytellers' fragile ideas grow, under a little protection and the right note, gave me the chance to see Pixar's whole philosophy of story work right in front of my eyes.

Now I've spent four years at Ogilvy applying that same philosophy, only in service of selling something. There, I learned that great ideas rarely die from being bad. They die from friction, from the hundred logistics and lost hours that crowd out the time to make them great. So I made myself the producer who always clears that: I steward the budgets, keep the productions on track, and build the tools and systems that chase the busywork off creatives' plates, so that time can go to the story, and the people telling it. That is the quiet work nobody sees, and it is the work I love most, because it is what lets the boldest, most "abominable" ideas survive long enough to become unforgettable.

At Ogilvy, all my work and skills moved one thing: product. But at Pixar, my experience and my work would move something more. They would move people, the way the stories once moved me as a child, the stories that taught me that by offering a snow cone, you could offer so much more. A place where the most abominable ideas can become the most adorable.

Thank you for reading this far. I can't imagine doing this anywhere else.

To Infinity & Beyond,

Isaac Boruchowicz Gamboa